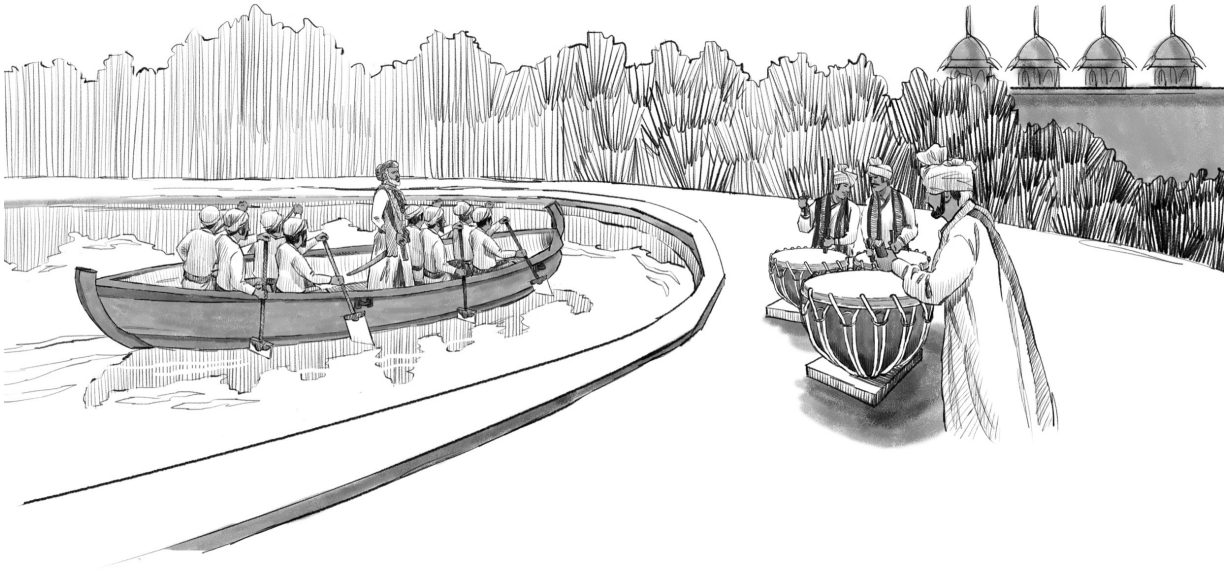
He had not forgotten Mumtaz. Taxes on nearby villages were spent to complete the work on the Taj Mahal and keep it in good condition.

But the Taj Mahal, the fort, and other building projects had drained the royal treasury. Unsuccessful wars added to the strains on the empire. After Shah Jahan fell ill in 1657, his four sons fought for control.



The winner was Aurangzeb, who defeated and executed all of his brothers. He declared himself emperor. When Shah Jahan recovered from his illness, he tried to take back the throne. But Aurangzeb would not give up power. He said Shah Jahan was not fit to rule and imprisoned him in the Red Fort in Agra.

Shah Jahan lived there for eight years, until his death in 1666. From the fort, he could gaze upon the monument he had built for his wife.